Contact

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www.linkedin.com/in/patricksoon (LinkedIn)
members.calbar.ca.gov/fal/Member/Detail/289063 (Other)
www.mywsba.org/PersonifyEbusiness/LegalDirectory/LegalProfile.aspx (Other)
www.avvo.com/attorneys/92660-ca-patrick-soon-4427372.html (Other)

Top Skills

Videogame law
Intellectual Property
Trademarks

Languages

Mandarin (Elementary)
English (Native or Bilingual)
Cantonese (Limited Working)
Japanese (Elementary)

Certifications

CIPP/C (Certified Information Privacy Professional - Canada)
Washington Bar License
California Bar License
CIPP/US (Certified Information Privacy Professional - United States)

Honors-Awards

Scholar
Hagman Scholar
CALI Excellence for the Future Award (IP Litigation)
Dean's Citation Award
Organization Leader of the Year

Publications

Five Technology Solutions to Make Law School Life Easier

Patrick Soon

Emerging Products Legal for ByteDance
Los Angeles Metropolitan Area

Experience

ByteDance

Product and Commercial Counsel, Global Emerging Business
2025 - Present (1 year)
Los Angeles, CA

-- EMERGING PRODUCTS: Work with legal and product teams globally to review new and existing B2C and B2B applications (e.g., mobile games, education and learning apps, virtual reality, artificial intelligence, etc.), products, features, and initiatives to provide legal risk mitigation strategies to ensure legal compliance for emerging products.

-- COMMERCIAL COUNSELING: Draft, review and negotiate a variety of commercial agreements, review marketing campaigns, assist with general transactions and other commercial matters for emerging products.

-- PRODUCT COUNSELING: Advise global product and business teams on the application of a wide range of laws and regulations, with a focus on intellectual property, consumer protection, data protection, content regulation, and online safety related laws.

-- COLLABORATION: Collaborate with product, product operations, enterprise and consumer sales, public policy, communications, privacy, trust & safety and other cross-functional colleagues on product launches, commercial partnerships and campaigns.

-- COORDINATION: Coordinate with other regional counsel and various subject matter expert legal groups.

Meta

5 years

Associate General Counsel
2022 - 2025 (3 years)
Los Angeles, California, United States

-- CONTENT PUBLISHING & DEVELOPMENT: Providing legal support to multiple award-winning AAA 1st and 2nd party VR content studios including

Delaware Chancery Court Arbitration Program Sued
Trademark Squatting in China: What Every American Business Should Know
Warning: Wearing Google Glass May Cause Legal Headaches (Part 1)
Google-fy Your Law Practice

“Beat Saber” (first $100 million revenue title on Quest), “Lone Echo 2” (2022 DICE Immersive Reality Experience of the Year), "Medal of Honor: Above and Beyond” (2021 Academy Award for Best Documentary Short Subject), “Resident Evil 4” (2021 The Game Awards Best VR/AR Title, 2022 SXSW Best VR Experience, and 2022 NY Game Awards Best Remake and Best VR Experience), and Batman: Arkham Shadow (2024 The Game Awards Best VR/AR Title).

-- ACQUISITIONS: Navigating internal operations and legal protocols to onboard vendors/employees/contracts in the acquisition of multiple independent interactive content studios since early 2020, including: Beat, Sanzaru, Ready at Dawn, Downpour, and BigBoxVR, etc.

-- DEALS: Advising business teams in the complex negotiation of multi-million dollar publishing deals with 3rd party studios (Oculus Publishing), external content development studios, IP licensors, middleware companies, external development houses, SAG talent, and other content production service providers.

-- COLLABORATION: Collaborating with legal subject matter experts at Meta and outside counsel to analyze and communicate legal risks across a range of issues including privacy, accessibility, virtual currency, integrity, employment, marketing, safety, competition, etc.

-- RELATIONSHIPS/TRAINING: Educating and building influence in strategic relationships with content producers, artists, studio heads, business development executives, marketing executives, cross-functional teams, and peers across the Reality Labs (RL)/Metaverse Content organization

-- COMMUNITY: Organizing team-wide, company-wide, and public events as steering committee lead for the APIs of Reality Labs and chapter ambassador for APIs @ Legal (LAX) business resource groups at Meta.

Lead Counsel
2020 - 2022 (2 years)
Los Angeles, California, United States

Square Enix
5 years

Senior Counsel, Business & Legal Affairs

2019 - 2020 (1 year)
Greater Los Angeles Area

-- GAME PUBLISHING & DEVELOPMENT: Advised Square Enix group's video game development and publishing operations throughout the Americas and Europe with special focus on North American game development studios' legal needs (e.g., open source code license review, work made for hire agreements, concept art review, performance capture agreements, music licenses, live services, and sunset/delisting of games, etc.)

-- PRODUCT COUNSELING: Provided product counseling and reviewed content of games and marketing platforms for various issues including privacy law compliance (e.g., COPPA, GDPR, Privacy Shield, CAN-SPAM, etc.), intellectual property clearance, and consumer protection/ratings

-- TRAINING/PUBLIC SPEAKING: Traveled to and educated diverse cross-functional development and publishing teams (i.e., Los Angeles, San Francisco, Seattle, Montreal, London, and Tokyo offices) about regulations and best legal practices

-- CONTRACT NEGOTIATION: Negotiated, drafted, and reviewed a variety of contracts including marketing, licensing, cloud computing, user data analysis, video game sales and distribution, software license, intellectual property content license, talent, likeness release, end user license, non-disclosure, and other general commercial agreements

-- RELATIONSHIPS: Built relationships and cooperated with legal and other cross-functional teams

-- OUTSIDE COUNSEL: Managed outside counsel on a variety of legal areas including real estate, employment, unions/guilds, immigration (for talent and employees with O-1, L-1, H1B, green cards, etc.), trademarks (100s of marks in portfolio), and contests/sweepstakes

-- NEW LAWS/REGULATIONS: Ensured compliance with novel laws affecting the industry (e.g., privacy, ecommerce, in-app purchases, data protection, virtual currency, accessibility, etc.) including game ratings by acting as company liaison to the ESRB Advertising Review Council to ensure company compliance with the group's industry guidelines

Counsel, Business & Legal Affairs
2016 - 2019 (3 years)

Greater Los Angeles Area

Associate Counsel, Business & Legal Affairs
2015 - 2016 (1 year)
Greater Los Angeles Area

WHGC, P.L.C. (f/k/a Wang, Hartmann, Gibbs, & Cauley, P.L.C.)
Associate Attorney
2013 - 2015 (2 years)

-- Assisted clients with their trademark portfolios including counseling on trademark availability, selection, enforcement, renewals, and handling all aspects of trademark prosecution including conducting and resolving inter-parties proceedings before the U.S. Trademark Trial and Appeal Board (TTAB).
-- Drafted comprehensive trademark search opinion letters, analyzing trademark searches, researching third party use, negotiating settlements, and clearance work with heavy volume, large international trademark portfolios, strategizing with clients regarding their business matters, licensing, advertising, and contracts.
-- Advising on copyright ability of client materials, obtaining copyright registrations on behalf of his clients, and handling related intellectual property business matters such as preparing assignments, licenses, and confidentiality agreements.
-- Provided contract review, revision, and drafting for various international companies with regards to high-technology, hardware manufacturing, distribution, and licensing.
-- Litigated intellectual property and business matters (including pretrial investigation, motion practice, discovery, witness preparation, and trial work)

Notable results:
-- Successfully resolved potential trademark litigation suit in New York state for similar marks in between two Japanese fine-dining restaurants
-- Successfully negotiated amicable trademark infringement settlement negotiation with major fashion designer in early federal litigation stages of district court for the 9th circuit resulting in the return of tens of thousands of in frozen funds for client
-- Successfully negotiated amicable trademark settlement with major US produce maker avoiding damages and fees altogether
-- Successfully negotiated amicable fee negotiation between client and private education entity in Virginia

Goodman Mooney LLP
Associate Attorney
2012 - 2013 (1 year)
Orange County, California Area

-- Drafted federal complaints involving federal trademark infringement (15 U.S.C. § 1114), trademark dilution (15 U.S.C. § 1125(c)(1)), federal false designation of origin/unfair competition (15 U.S.C. § 1125(a)), California false advertising (§17500), California unfair competition (§§ 17200), and California trademark infringement (§§14245) and dilution (§§14247) causes of action
-- Experienced in TTAB (Trademark Trial and Appeal Board) trial testimony proceedings through drafting, researching, and preparing sworn declarations, notices of reliance, and judicial notices for internet documents, dictionary terms, document production, and responses to interrogatories
-- Experienced in TTAB trademark opposition proceedings through drafting answers, motions to consolidate, and certificates of service
-- Drafted asset operating agreements, service agreements, and asset-transfer agreements for manufacturing companies
-- Drafted privacy policy and terms of service for new online entities involving intellectual property concerns, browser cookies, use of data collected, choice of law, and Child Online Privacy Protection Act (COPPA) considerations
-- Drafted letters to collections agencies and state corporate licensing authorities
-- Familiar with Clio law firm scheduling/billing software, MS outlook, TTABvue website, and USPTO website

Superior Court of the District of Columbia
Law Clerk
2011 - 2011 (less than a year)

- Clerked for the Honorable Michael J. McCarthy full-time in a summer internship program observing judicial decisions, courtroom procedure, and conducting legal research
- Awarded $1500 stipend from the American Bar Association
- Selected from hundreds of applicants through three screening rounds in the American Bar Association's Section of Litigation Judicial Intern Opportunity Program (ABA JIOP)

Red Hat Society
Law Clerk
2010 - 2010 (less than a year)

-- Drafted trademarks and defamation cease and desist letters

-- Targeted online defamation, unfair competition, and trademark infringement of company IP

-- Authored memoranda addressing strategic international trademark enforcement, non-profits

Allergan

Law Clerk

2010 - 2010 (less than a year)

-- Reviewed company-owned chemical patents against prior art in foreign scientific publications

-- Responded to United States Patent and Trademark Office (USPTO) actions

-- Authored memoranda on extension of indicia (uses) for company-owned patents

The University of British Columbia - Annual Giving Phone Program (Development)

Project Assistant and Records Keeper

2006 - 2009 (3 years)

-- Personally fund--raised over $50,000 for scholarships, stipends, and campaigns. Promoted sustained financial support using proven cold--calling techniques.

-- Twice awarded “Caller of the Month” distinction by UBC Annual Giving Associate Director and Development Officer for continually surpassing employee statistics and chairing a committee to create social and team--building events for student employees.

Education

Whittier Law School

Doctor of Law (J.D.), Intellectual Property Law

The University of British Columbia

Bachelor of Science (B.Sc.), Life Sciences

UNH Franklin Pierce School of Law

Chinese Intellectual Property Law Summer Institute

Tsinghua University

Chinese Intellectual Property Summer Institute

St. George's School

High School Diploma